

CPSC-354 Report

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Abstract

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1 Introduction

2 Week by Week

2.1 Week 1

2.1.1 Homework

Here is my work on the MU Puzzle:

$$MIU \rightarrow MIUIU \rightarrow MIUIUIU \rightarrow \dots$$

$$MI \rightarrow MII \rightarrow MIII \rightarrow MUI \Rightarrow MUI$$

$$MUI \rightarrow MUIU$$

$$MUI \rightarrow MUIU \rightarrow MUIUIU \rightarrow MUIUIUIU \rightarrow MUUIU \rightarrow MUUIUIU \rightarrow \dots$$

$$MUIIU \rightarrow MUIIUUIU \rightarrow MUIU$$

$$MUIIU \rightarrow MUUIU \rightarrow MUIU$$

$$MUIU \rightarrow MUUIU \rightarrow MUIUIU \rightarrow MUIUIUIU \rightarrow \dots$$

$$MUIUIUIU \rightarrow MUIUIUIUIU \rightarrow MUIUIUIUIUIU \rightarrow \dots$$

The MU Puzzle is unsolvable because it is impossible to reach the string MU starting from MI using the given rules. After a little research and thinking on my part it is the number of I's that make this impossible: rule applications can double the count, add one, or remove three at a time, however, none of these operations ever reduce the number of I's to exactly zero. Since MU has no I's, it can never be derived.

2.1.2 Questions

What rules could we add or remove in order to make this possible? I was thinking are there any ways to make this question solvable by adding only one more rule or maybe altering a rule. I think that this is an interesting question and concept.

2.2 Week 2

2.2.1 Homework

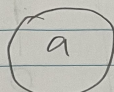
Here is my work on the Rewriting Homework:

Rewriting

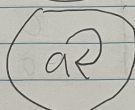
1. $A = \{\}$



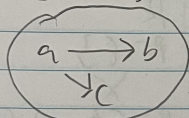
2. $A = \{a\}$ $R = \{\}$



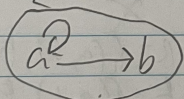
3. $A = \{a\}$ $R = \{(a, a)\}$



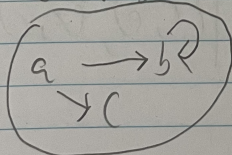
4. $A = \{a, b, c\}$ $R = \{(a, b), (a, c)\}$



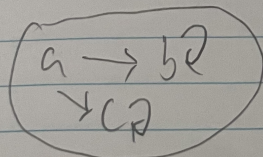
5. $A = \{a, b\}$ $R = \{(a, a), (a, b)\}$



6. $A = \{a, b, c\}$ $R = \{(a, b), (b, b), (a, c)\}$



7. $A = \{a, b, c\}$ $R = \{(a, b), (b, b), (a, c), (c, c)\}$



0 = false
1 = true

C = confluent
+ = terminating
U = unique normal form

	Confluent	terminating	unique normal form
1.	1	1	1
2.	0	1	1
3.	1	0	1
4.	0	1	0
5.	1	0	1
6.	0	0	1
7.	0	0	0

	C	+	U	A	R
2.	1	1	1	$A = \{a\}$	$R = \{\}$
	1	1	0	X	X
5.	1	0	1	$A = \{a, b\}$	$R = \{(a, a), (a, b)\}$
	1	0	0	X	X
	0	1	1	X	X
4.	0	1	0	$A = \{a, b, c\}$	$R = \{(a, b), (a, c)\}$
6.	0	0	1	$A = \{a, b, c\}$	$R = \{(a, b), (a, c), (b, b)\}$
	0	0	0	$A = \{a, b, c, d, e, f\}$	$R = \{(a, b), (a, c), (b, d), (c, e), (f, f)\}$

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 a & \rightarrow & b \\
 \downarrow & & \downarrow \\
 c & & d \\
 & \searrow & \\
 & e &
 \end{array}$$
 FR

In our homework we discovered 3 separate combinations that are impossible to create. The first confluent, terminating and no unique normal form is impossible because if a system is confluent and terminating then it must have a unique normal form. The second confluent, not terminating and no unique normal form is impossible because if a system is confluent but not terminating then it must have a unique normal form when it exists. The third not confluent, terminating and unique normal form is impossible because if a system is terminating and has a unique normal form then it must be confluent.

2.2.2 Questions

When relating to programming, if a system is confluent but not terminating, like in some programs with infinite loops, how does confluence still guarantee that the result of a program is unique when it exists?

2.3 Week 3

2.3.1 Homework

Here is the work on ARS rewriting HW:

Exercise 5:

- Reduce some example strings such as **abba** and **bababa**.

$$abba \rightarrow baba \rightarrow baab \rightarrow bb \rightarrow b \rightarrow \{\}$$

$$bababa \rightarrow baabba \rightarrow bbba \rightarrow bba \rightarrow ba \rightarrow a$$

- Why is the ARS not terminating?
The ARS is not terminating because you can infinitely go from ab to ba and vice versa.
- How many equivalence classes does $\leftrightarrow^*$ have? Can you describe them in a nice way? What are the normal forms?
There are two equivalence classes: words with an even number of a 's vs words with an odd number of a 's.
The normal forms are the empty string $\{\}$ and the string **a**.
- Can you change the rules so that the ARS becomes terminating without changing its equivalence classes?
You can change $ba \rightarrow ab$ to $ba \rightarrow b$. This keeps the same equivalence classes but makes the system terminating.
- Write down a question or two about strings that can be answered using the ARS.
 - Does this string reduce to the empty string?
 - Are two given strings equivalent under the ARS?

Exercise 5b:

- Reduce some example strings such as **abba** and **bababa**.

$$abba \rightarrow baba \rightarrow baab \rightarrow bab \rightarrow ba \rightarrow a$$

$$bababa \rightarrow baabba \rightarrow babba \rightarrow baba \rightarrow aba \rightarrow aa \rightarrow a$$

- Why is the ARS not terminating?
The ARS is not terminating because you can infinitely go from ab to ba and vice versa.
- How many equivalence classes does $\leftrightarrow^*$ have? Can you describe them in a nice way? What are the normal forms?
There is one equivalence class: all words reduce to one a .
The normal form is just **a**.

- Can you change the rules so that the ARS becomes terminating without changing its equivalence classes?
You can change $ba \rightarrow ab$ to $ba \rightarrow b$. This keeps the same equivalence classes but makes the system terminating.
- Write down a question or two about strings that can be answered using the ARS.
 - Is there a unique normal form for this ARS?
 - Are two given strings equivalent under the ARS?

Bonus: Exercise 8

- Starting configuration:

$aaaaaaaaaaaaabbbbbbbbbbbcccccccccccc$
 $\rightarrow^* acccccccccccccccccccccccccccccccc$
 $\rightarrow bcccccccccccccccccccccccccccccccc$
 $\rightarrow^* bbbbbbbcccccccccccccccccccccccccccc$

- It is impossible to reach a configuration of only a 's, only b 's, or only c 's.
- At each step, the rules correspond to the following change-vectors:

$$(a - 1, b - 1, c + 2), \quad (a - 1, b + 2, c - 1), \quad (a + 2, b - 1, c - 1)$$

- Reducing these modulo 3 gives

$$(-1, -1, -1)$$

for each move (since $+2 \equiv -1 \pmod{3}$).

- Thus, we can simply subtract the numbers of a 's, b 's, and c 's directly:

$$a - b = 15 - 14 = 1 \pmod{3}$$

$$b - c = 14 - 13 = 1 \pmod{3}$$

- Since these differences never reduce to 0, there will always be one leftover letter that prevents the string from reducing to a uniform string of only a 's, b 's, or c 's.

Questions Given the rules for changing letters in Exercise 8 ARS, why is it impossible to end up with a string containing only one type of letter, and how can we use modular arithmetic to prove it?

2.4 Week 4

2.4.1 Homework

HW 4.1

Consider the following algorithm:

```

while b != 0:
    temp = b
    b = a mod b
    a = temp
return a

```

Under certain conditions this algorithm always terminates. In order for the algorithm to terminate:

- $b \geq 0$
- $a \geq 0$
- a and b must be integers, since doubles may cause unexpected mod results

A suitable measure function is:

$$m(a, b) = b$$

Proof of termination: Each iteration replaces b with $a \bmod b$, which is always strictly smaller than the previous b but still nonnegative. Since b is a nonnegative integer, it cannot decrease indefinitely, so eventually $b = 0$ and the loop terminates.

HW 4.2

Consider the following fragment of an implementation of merge sort:

```
function merge_sort(arr, left, right):  
    if left >= right:  
        return  
    mid = (left + right) / 2  
    merge_sort(arr, left, mid)  
    merge_sort(arr, mid+1, right)  
    merge(arr, left, mid, right)
```

We define the measure function:

$$m(left, right) = right - left + 1$$

Proof:

- m maps to positive integers when $left \leq right$ since $m \geq 1$. If $left \geq right$ the function returns immediately (base case).
- If $left < right$ then $left \leq mid < right$, so both recursive calls shrink the measure:

$$m(left, mid) = mid - left + 1 < right - left + 1 = m(left, right)$$

$$m(mid + 1, right) = right - mid < right - left + 1 = m(left, right)$$

Thus both recursive calls are on strictly smaller natural numbers.

- The natural numbers have no infinite strictly decreasing sequence, so repeated decreases of m force termination.

Therefore $m(left, right) = right - left + 1$ is a valid measure function for `merge_sort`: it is integer-valued, nonnegative, and strictly decreases on every recursive call.

2.4.2 Questions

Question: In a recursive backtracking algorithm, the procedure explores possible options and recurses until either a valid solution is found or all possibilities are exhausted. Since recursion can branch in many ways, how can we define a measure function that guarantees termination of the backtracking process, and what does this reveal about the relationship between the number of remaining choices and the maximum recursive depth?

2.5 Week 5

2.5.1 Homework

Here is the work on the lambda calculus evaluation:

$$(\lambda f. \lambda x. f(f(x))) (\lambda f. \lambda x. f(f(f x)))$$

Rename $f \mapsto g$ and $x \mapsto z$ in the second term:

$$(\lambda f. \lambda x. f(f(x))) (\lambda g. \lambda z. g(g(gz)))$$

$$\rightarrow (\lambda x. (\lambda g. \lambda z. g(g(gz))) ((\lambda g. \lambda z. g(g(gz))) x))$$

$$\rightarrow (\lambda x. (\lambda g. \lambda z. g(g(gz))) (\lambda z. x(x(xz))))$$

$$\rightarrow (\lambda x. \lambda z. ((\lambda z. x(x(xz))))(((\lambda z. x(x(xz))))((\lambda z. x(x(xz))))z)))$$

$$\rightarrow (\lambda x. \lambda z. ((\lambda z. x(x(xz)))) ((\lambda z. x(x(xz)))) (x(x(xz))))$$

$$\rightarrow (\lambda x. \lambda z. ((\lambda z. x(x(xz)))) (x(x(x(x(x(xz))))))))$$

$$\rightarrow (\lambda x. \lambda z. x(x(x(x(x(x(x(xz))))))))$$

2.5.2 Questions

Why is β -equivalence considered fundamental in the lambda calculus, and how does it affect the way we define substitution and reduction?

2.6 Week 6

2.6.1 Homework

Here is the step-by-step evaluation of the factorial function in λ -calculus:

$$\text{let rec fact} = \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * \text{fact}(n - 1) \text{ in fact } 3$$

$$\rightarrow (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1))) 3$$

$$\rightarrow ((\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1)) (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1)))) 3$$

$$\rightarrow (\lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1))))(n - 1)) 3$$

$$\begin{aligned}
& \rightarrow \text{if } 3 = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } 3 * (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1)))(3 - 1)) \\
& \rightarrow 3 * (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1))) 2) \\
& \rightarrow 3 * ((\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1)) (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1)))) 2) \\
& \rightarrow 3 * (\lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1)))(n - 1)) 2) \\
& \rightarrow 3 * (\text{if } 2 = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } 2 * (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1)))(2 - 1))) \\
& \rightarrow 3 * 2 * (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1))) 1) \\
& \rightarrow 3 * 2 * (\lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1)))(n - 1)) 1) \\
& \rightarrow 3 * 2 * (\text{if } 1 = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } 1 * (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1)))(1 - 1))) \\
& \rightarrow 3 * 2 * 1 * (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1))) 0) \\
& \rightarrow 3 * 2 * 1 * (\lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1)))(n - 1)) 0) \\
& \rightarrow 3 * 2 * 1 * (\text{if } 0 = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } 0 * (\text{fix}(\lambda f. \lambda n. \text{if } n = 0 \text{ then } 1 \text{ else } n * f(n - 1)))(0 - 1))) \\
& \rightarrow 3 * 2 * 1 * 1 = 6
\end{aligned}$$

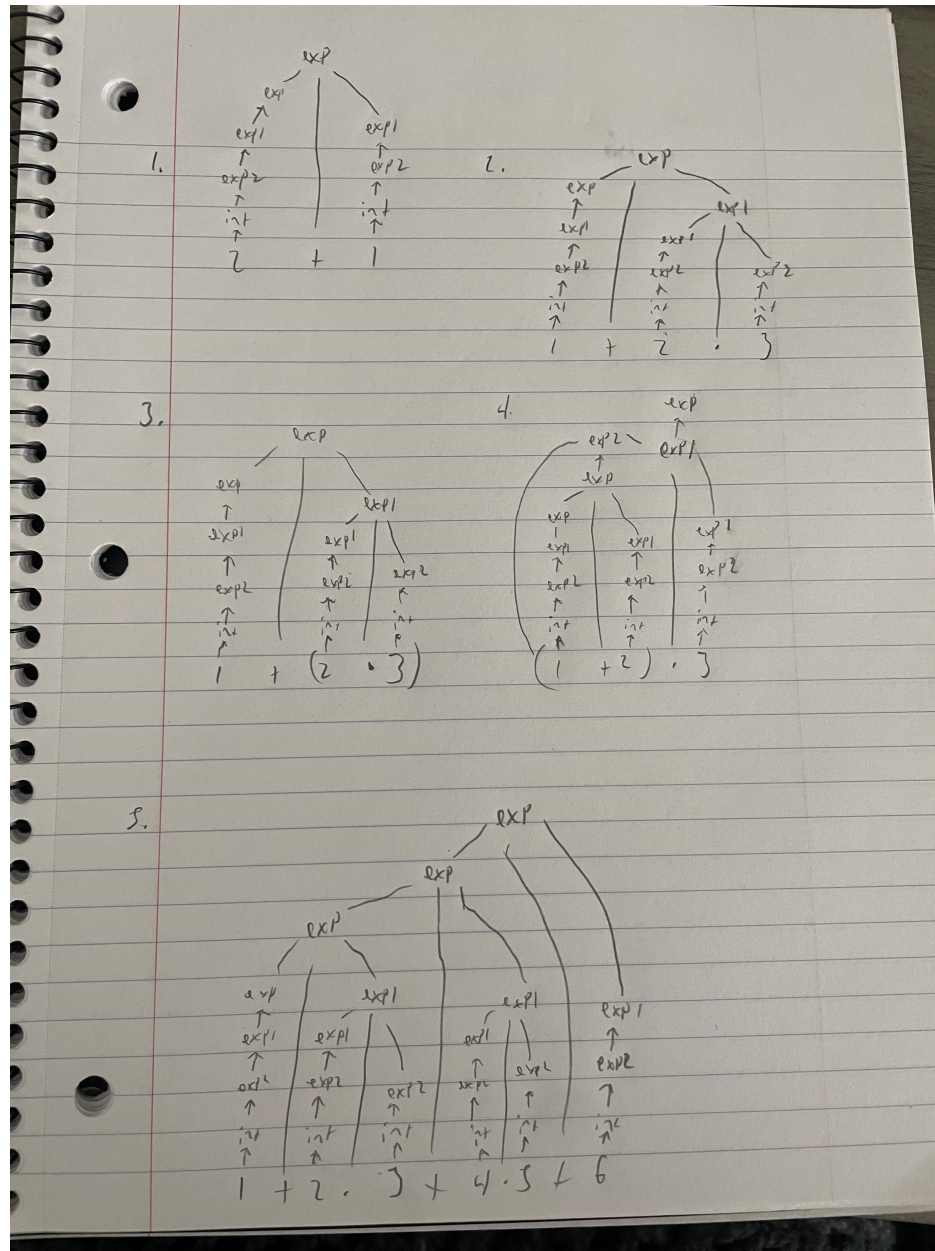
2.6.2 Questions

In this example, the `fix` operator allows us to define recursive behavior without explicit recursion syntax. How does the use of `fix` in λ -calculus compare to the use of recursion in functional programming languages, and why is this fixed-point construction needed for expressing general recursive functions in a purely functional system?

2.7 Week 7

2.7.1 Homework

Here is my homework for context free grammar trees:



2.7.2 Questions

In context-free grammars, how does introducing precedence levels (like Exp, Exp1, Exp2) formally enforce operator precedence compared to simply defining $\text{Exp} \rightarrow \text{Exp} + \text{Exp} \mid \text{Exp} * \text{Exp} \mid \text{Integer}$?

2.8 Week 8

2.8.1 Homework

Here is my work for the Lean proofs from the report.txt file:

Level 5:

```
rw [add_zero]
rw [add_zero]
rfl
```

Level 6:

```
rw [add_zero c]
rw [add_zero b]
rfl
```

Level 7:

```
rw [one_eq_succ_zero]
rw [add_succ]
rw [add_zero]
rfl
```

Level 8:

```
nth_rewrite 2 [two_eq_succ_one]
rw [add_succ]
rw [succ_eq_add_one]
nth_rewrite 1 [two_eq_succ_one]
rw [succ_eq_add_one]
rw [four_eq_succ_three]
nth_rewrite 1 [succ_eq_add_one]
rw [three_eq_succ_two]
rw [succ_eq_add_one]
rw [two_eq_succ_one]
rw [succ_eq_add_one]
rfl
```

2.8.2 Natural Language Proof (for Level 7)

In natural language we start with the statement that $1 + a = \text{succ}(a)$, where $\text{succ}(x)$ denotes the successor of x (that is, $x + 1$).

1. By definition, $1 = \text{succ}(0)$.
2. Substitute this into the left-hand side: $\text{succ}(0) + a$.
3. Using the recursive definition of addition, $\text{succ}(m) + n = \text{succ}(m + n)$. So, $\text{succ}(0) + a = \text{succ}(0 + a)$.
4. Next, by the base case of addition, $0 + a = a$.
5. Therefore, $\text{succ}(0 + a) = \text{succ}(a)$.
6. Hence, $1 + a = \text{succ}(a)$.

this shows that the proof follows directly from the base and inductive definitions of addition and the successor function in arithmetic.

2.8.3 Questions

When mathematicians informally rely on “obvious” or “intuitive” steps (like symmetry or associativity), how can such steps be represented in formal verification systems?

2.9 Week 9

2.9.1 Homework

Here is my work for the Lean induction proofs:

Exercise 1:

```
induction n
rw [add_zero]
rfl
rw [add_succ]
rw [n_ih]
rfl
```

Exercise 2:

```
induction b
repeat rw [add_zero]
rfl
repeat rw [add_succ]
rw [n_ih]
rfl
```

Exercise 3:

```
induction b
rw [add_zero]
rw [zero_add]
rfl
rw [add_succ]
rw [succ_add]
rw [n_ih]
rfl
```

Exercise 4:

```
induction c
repeat rw
[add_zero]
rfl repeat
rw [add_succ]
rw [n_ih]
rfl
```

Exercise 5 (No Induction):

```

rw [add_assoc]
rw [add_assoc]
rw [add_comm b c]
rfl

```

Exercise 5 (Induction):

```

induction b
rw [add_zero]
rw [add_zero]
rfl rw [add_succ]
rw [succ_add]
rw [add_succ]
rw [n_ih]
rfl

```

Pen and paper proof for exercise 5:

$$\begin{aligned}
 & a + b + c = a + c + b \\
 & a + b + c = (a + b) + c \quad \text{def assoc} \\
 & = a + (b + c) \quad \text{def assoc} \\
 & = a + (c + b) \quad \text{def comm} \\
 & = (a + c) + b \quad \text{def assoc} \\
 & = a + c + b \\
 & + \text{KUS} \quad a + b + c = a + c + b \\
 \\
 & b = 0 \\
 & a + 0 + c = (a + 0) + c \quad \text{def assoc} \\
 & = a + c \quad \text{def +} \\
 \\
 & a + c + 0 = (a + c) + 0 \quad \text{def assoc} \\
 & = a + c \quad \text{def +} \\
 & + \text{KUS} \quad a + 0 + c = a + c + 0 \\
 \\
 & a + (k + 1) + c = (a + (k + 1)) + c \quad \text{def assoc} \\
 & = (a + k) + 1 + c \quad \text{def +} \\
 & = (a + k) + (1 + c) \quad \text{def assoc} \\
 & = (a + k) + (c + 1) \quad \text{def comm} \\
 & = (a + c) + (k + 1) \quad \text{by IH} \\
 & = a + c + (k + 1) \quad \text{def assoc} \\
 & + \text{KUS} \quad a + (k + 1) + c = a + c + (k + 1) \quad \checkmark
 \end{aligned}$$

2.9.2 Questions

When performing induction in Lean, why is it necessary to explicitly handle both the base and inductive cases, and how does Lean's treatment of recursive definitions ensure that each step of the induction corresponds to a structurally smaller argument?

2.10 Week 10

This week, we continued working in Lean, focusing on constructing proofs using `exact` statements and lambda expressions (λ).

1. **Exercise 6:**

`exact  $\lambda c \mapsto \text{and\_intro } c \gg h$`

2. **Exercise 7:**

`exact  $\lambda \langle c, d \rangle \mapsto h \ c \ d$`

3. **Exercise 8:**

`exact  $\lambda (s : S) \mapsto \text{and\_intro } (h.\text{left } s) (h.\text{right } s)$`

4. **Exercise 9:**

`exact  $\lambda (r : R) \mapsto \text{and\_intro } (\lambda (\_ : S) \mapsto r) (\lambda (\_ : \neg S) \mapsto r)$`

2.10.1 Questions

Question: How does Lean use λ -abstraction and `and_intro` to represent logical conjunction ($\wedge$) in proofs?

2.11 Week 11

This week, we continued working in Lean, focusing on constructing proofs using negation.

1. **Exercise 9:**

`exact  $\lambda (a : P \wedge A) \mapsto h \ a.\text{left } a.\text{right}$`

2. **Exercise 10:**

`exact  $\lambda (p : P) (a : A) \mapsto h \ (\text{and\_intro } p \ a)$`

3. **Exercise 11:**

`exact  $\lambda a \mapsto h \ (\lambda na \mapsto na \ a)$`

4. **Exercise 12:**

`exact  $\lambda nb \mapsto h \ (nb \gg \text{false\_elim})$`

2.11.1 Questions

Question: How can falsification be modeled within Lean's constructive logic, where the law of excluded middle does not hold, and what does this reveal about representing scientific reasoning in type theory?

2.12 Week 12

2.12.1 Homework

Here is my work on the Towers of Hanoi problem with 5 disks:

```
hanoi 5 0 2
  hanoi 4 0 1
    hanoi 3 0 2
      hanoi 2 0 1
        hanoi 1 0 2 = move 0 2
        move 0 1
        hanoi 1 2 1 = move 2 1
      move 0 2
      hanoi 2 1 2
        hanoi 1 1 0 = move 1 0
        move 1 2
        hanoi 1 0 2 = move 0 2
    move 0 1
    hanoi 3 2 1
      hanoi 2 2 0
        hanoi 1 2 1 = move 2 1
        move 2 0
        hanoi 1 1 0 = move 1 0
      move 2 1
      hanoi 2 0 1
        hanoi 1 0 2 = move 0 2
        move 0 1
        hanoi 1 2 1 = move 2 1
    move 0 2
    hanoi 4 1 2
      hanoi 3 1 0
        hanoi 2 1 2
          hanoi 1 1 0 = move 1 0
          move 1 2
          hanoi 1 0 2 = move 0 2
        move 1 0
        hanoi 2 2 0
          hanoi 1 2 1 = move 2 1
          move 2 0
          hanoi 1 1 0 = move 1 0
      move 1 2
      hanoi 3 0 2
        hanoi 2 0 1
          hanoi 1 0 2 = move 0 2
          move 0 1
          hanoi 1 2 1 = move 2 1
        move 0 2
        hanoi 2 1 2
          hanoi 1 1 0 = move 1 0
          move 1 2
          hanoi 1 0 2 = move 0 2
```

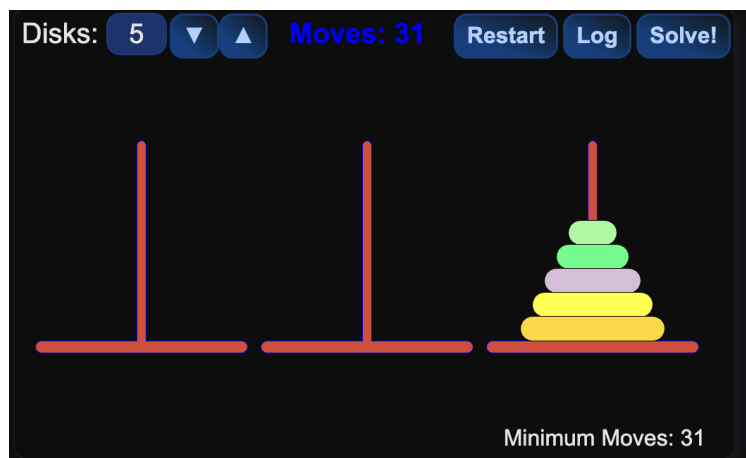
```

move 0 2
move 0 1
move 2 1
move 0 2
move 1 0
move 1 2
move 0 2
move 0 1
move 2 1
move 2 0
move 1 0
move 2 1
move 0 2
move 0 1
move 2 1
move 0 2
move 1 0
move 1 2
move 0 2
move 1 0
move 2 1
move 2 0
move 1 0
move 1 2
move 0 2
move 0 1
move 2 1
move 0 2
move 1 0
move 1 2
move 0 2

```

The Towers of Hanoi solution for 5 disks requires 31 moves, which follows the formula $2^n - 1$ where n is the number of disks.

Here is a visualization of the completed Towers of Hanoi with all 5 rings moved from peg 1 to peg 3:



2.12.2 Questions

How does the recursive solution for n disks relate to the mathematical proof that the minimal number of moves required is $2^n - 1$, and what insights does this provide about the relationship between recursive algorithms and mathematical induction?

2.13 Week 13

2.13.1 Homework

Question 1: Does our Python implementation of lambda calculus conforms to its specification given by its mathematical theory?

After reviewing the specifications of lambda calculus and comparing it to our Python implementation, I think that there are some discrepancies that indicate our implementation does not fully conform to the specification.

Question 2: Testing Lambda Expressions

I created some more test cases in `test.lc`:

```
// Basic identity function
(\x.x) a

// Function application associativity
a b c d
(a)

// Church booleans
(\x.\y.x) a b // true - should return a
(\x.\y.y) a b // true - should return b

// Church numerals and arithmetic
(\f.\x.f(f x)) // Church numeral 2
(\f.\x.f(f(f x))) // Church numeral 3

// Multiplication: 2 * 3 = 6
((\m.\n. m n) (\f.\x. f (f x))) (\f.\x. f (f (f x)))
```

Expected vs Actual Results:

- $(\lambda x.x) a \rightarrow a$ (identity function applied to a)
- $a b c d \rightarrow (((a b) c) d)$ (left-associativity)
- $(a) \rightarrow a$ (parentheses don't change meaning)
- $(\lambda x.\lambda y.x) a b \rightarrow a$ (true returns first argument)
- $(\lambda x.\lambda y.y) a b \rightarrow b$ (true returns second argument)
- Church numeral stopped after certain amount of reductions due to implementation limits (should represent 2 and 3)

Question 3: Capture Avoiding Substitution

The substitution algorithm works as follows:

```
def substitute(tree, name, replacement):
```

```

if tree[0] == 'var':
if tree[1] == name:
return replacement # n [r/n]  r
else:
return tree # x [r/n]  x
elif tree[0] == 'lam':
if tree[1] == name:
return tree # \n.e [r/n]  \n.e
else:
fresh_name = name_generator.generate()
return ('lam', fresh_name,
substitute(substitute(tree[2], tree[1], ('var', fresh_name)),
name, replacement))
# \x.e [r/n]  (\fresh.(e[fresh/x])) [r/n]
elif tree[0] == 'app':
return ('app', substitute(tree[1], name, replacement),
substitute(tree[2], name, replacement))

```

Key Insight: When substituting into `\x.e` where `x` `name`, we generate a fresh variable to avoid capture, rename `x` to the fresh name in the body, then perform the substitution.

Question 5: Minimal Working Example that doesn't reduce to normal form

The smallest meaningful MWE that fails in the original interpreter:

```
a ((\x.x) b)
```

Why this fails:

- Current behavior: `a ((\x.x) b)` stays as `a ((\x.x) b)`
- Expected behavior: Should reduce to `a b`
- Reason: The original interpreter only evaluates the function position, not the argument position

Question 7: Tracing Evaluation Steps

Tracing `((\m.\n. m n) (\f.\x. f (f x))) (\f.\x. f x)`:

```

((\m.\n. m n) (\f.\x. f (f x))) (\f.\x. f x)
→ ((\n. (\f.\x. f (f x)) n) (\f.\x. f x)
→ ((\f.\x. f (f x)) (\f.\x. f x))
→ (\x. (\f.\x. f x) ((\f.\x. f x) x))
→ (\x. (\f.\x. f x) (\x. x x)) [incorrect - demonstrates capture issue]

```

The trace revealed that the original interpreter didn't fully reduce expressions due to incomplete evaluation strategy.

Question 8: Recursive Evaluation Trace

```

12: eval(((\m.\n. m n) (\f.\x. f (f x))) (\f.\x. f x))
12: eval((\m.\n. m n) (\f.\x. f (f x)))
12: eval(\m.\n. m n)
    return: (\m.\n. m n)
12: eval(\f.\x. f (f x))
    return: (\f.\x. f (f x))
app of lam: substitute((\n. m n), m, (\f.\x. f (f x)))
39: substitute((\n. m n), m, (\f.\x. f (f x)))

```

```

39: substitute(\n. m n, m, (\f.\x. f (f x)))
39: substitute(m n, m, (\f.\x. f (f x)))
39: substitute(m, m, (\f.\x. f (f x)))
    return: (\f.\x. f (f x))
39: substitute(n, m, (\f.\x. f (f x)))
    return: n
    return: ((\f.\x. f (f x)) n)
    return: (\n. ((\f.\x. f (f x)) n))
return: (\n. ((\f.\x. f (f x)) n))
12: eval((\n. ((\f.\x. f (f x)) n)) (\f.\x. f x))
app of lam: substitute(((\f.\x. f (f x)) n), n, (\f.\x. f x))
39: substitute(((\f.\x. f (f x)) n), n, (\f.\x. f x))
39: substitute((\f.\x. f (f x)), n, (\f.\x. f x))
    return: (\f.\x. f (f x))
39: substitute(n, n, (\f.\x. f x))
    return: (\f.\x. f x)
    return: ((\f.\x. f (f x)) (\f.\x. f x))
return: ((\f.\x. f (f x)) (\f.\x. f x))
12: eval((\f.\x. f (f x)) (\f.\x. f x))
12: eval(\f.\x. f (f x))
    return: (\f.\x. f (f x))
12: eval(\f.\x. f x)
    return: (\f.\x. f x)
app of lam: substitute(\x. f (f x), f, (\f.\x. f x))
39: substitute(\x. f (f x), f, (\f.\x. f x))
39: substitute(f (f x), f, (\f.\x. f x))
39: substitute(f, f, (\f.\x. f x))
    return: (\f.\x. f x)
39: substitute((f x), f, (\f.\x. f x))
39: substitute(f, f, (\f.\x. f x))
    return: (\f.\x. f x)
39: substitute(x, f, (\f.\x. f x))
    return: x
    return: ((\f.\x. f x) x)
    return: ((\f.\x. f x) ((\f.\x. f x) x))
    return: (\x. ((\f.\x. f x) ((\f.\x. f x) x)))
return: (\x. ((\f.\x. f x) ((\f.\x. f x) x)))
12: eval(\x. ((\f.\x. f x) ((\f.\x. f x) x)))
    return: (\x. ((\f.\x. f x) ((\f.\x. f x) x)))
final result: (\x. ((\f.\x. f x) ((\f.\x. f x) x)))

```

In the trace above i substituted the actual letter vs what the computer using var1-5 to represent variables internally.

2.13.2 Questions

In lambda calculus, the choice between applicative order (evaluating arguments first) and normal order (evaluating function first) evaluation strategies can lead to different termination behavior. How does this choice in our interpreter implementation reflect the fundamental trade-offs between efficiency and completeness in computational systems, and what does this reveal about the relationship between evaluation strategies and the Church-Rosser theorem in guaranteeing consistent results regardless of evaluation order?

3 Essay

4 Evidence of Participation

- Attended all lectures and actively participated in discussions.
- Completed weekly homework assignments and submitted them on time.

Seminar attendance:

In a seminar I attended I heard from Shaun Andrews, a Senior Data Analyst at Boeing and a Chapman University alumnus. Shaun shared valuable insights into his career path, explaining how the role of a data analyst can evolve into data science and beyond. He walked us through the full data process, from data cleaning and preparation to analysis, visualization, and communicating findings to stakeholders. He emphasized that advancing in the field is not only about technical skills, but also about learning how to tell meaningful stories with data. A major focus of his talk was data visualization. He highlighted how important it is to transform complex datasets into clear, impactful visuals that drive decision-making. His primary tool that he showed us is Tableau, and he demonstrated how he uses dashboards to monitor trends and support large-scale projects at Boeing. He also walked us through a case study involving aircraft sensor data, showing how visualization helped identify unusual patterns that improved predictive maintenance. I found a strong connection to my own internship experience, where I used Grafana and Power BI to build performance dashboards and monitor key metrics. Shaun briefly discussed Power BI as well, showing how these visualization tools are used across industries.

5 Conclusion

Looking back, this course connected a lot of dots for me between theory and the code I actually write. Starting with the puzzles like MU and abstract rewriting systems it was super abstract at first, but it framed a really important concept. How do we know a set of rules (or a program) will eventually stop and give us an answer? Tracing lambda calculus reductions by hand, and then seeing the same concepts break down in our Python interpreter project at the end, showed us why formal models matter.

The shift to Lean was also a very interesting part of what we learned. Having the system reject my "obvious" steps forced me to understand the exact logic behind things like induction or commutativity, which I normally take for granted. It made me appreciate the precision required for verification in critical systems, like the ones discussed in the Boeing seminar I attended.

The most useful takeaway is a new lens for problem-solving. I now think more about the underlying "rewrite system", the state changes, termination conditions, and equivalence classes of my data and how code are run. This mindset is directly applicable to software engineering, whether I'm designing an API, optimizing an algorithm, or debugging a complex state machine. For future iterations of the course, I'd suggest even earlier hands-on projects and programming assignments, to help understand the theory immediately.

References

[BLA] Author, [Title](#), Publisher, Year.